

Merging Table Rows And Columns

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What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can:

- Use the `colspan` attribute to merge cells across multiple columns.
- Use the `rowspan` attribute to merge cells across multiple rows.
- Create an organized HTML table using merged cells.

Before We Start

Look at a class schedule or calendar.

Have you noticed that some labels cover several columns or rows? HTML allows us to combine table cells to create a clearer and more organized table.

Let's Understand

HTML tables normally contain separate cells. However, some information may need to cover more than one column or row.

Merging Columns with colspan

The colspan attribute allows one cell to cover multiple columns.

```
<th colspan="3">Monday Schedule</th>
```

The number 3 means that the table heading covers three columns.

The colspan attribute can be used with both <th> and <td> elements.

Merging Rows with rowspan

The rowspan attribute allows one cell to cover multiple rows.

```
<td rowspan="2">Computer Club</td>
```

The number 2 means that the table cell covers two rows.

The rowspan attribute can also be used with both <th> and <td> elements.

Let's Practice

Complete the missing attribute values.

1. Make the heading cover four columns.

```
<th colspan="____">Student Information</th>
```

1. Make the Grade 10 cell cover three student rows.

```
<td rowspan="____">Grade 10</td>
```

1. Create a simple table containing:

- A caption
- Three columns
- A heading that covers all three columns
- One cell that covers two rows

Resources / References

- Text editor
- Web browser
- Previous lessons about HTML tables, rows, cells, headings, and captions